

- It's a homework question
- It asks about how Google and Google Answers works
- It's vague or frivolous, such as "Do you like blue?"

And so on. This is a place for serious research.

5.3 What Can You Expect?

Typically, for a question like our nanotechnology example above, you can expect a decently long write-up followed by lots of links where you can find further information. For simpler questions, you can expect brief, to-the-point answers. Like we said, you can also expect random people to comment on your question, which in themselves can contain a wealth of information.

What kinds of questions are answered for low prices? Here's one example we found: "How do you disable images in Firefox?" The question was answered, and the price was \$3, in addition to the 50-cent insertion charge. So imagine paying \$3.50 (Rs 160) for something as simple as this!

One thing we must mention is that Google Answers can help you get information you wouldn't get anywhere else, in certain cases. For example, what if you needed something translated into a foreign language or vice-versa, for an important purpose? Online translators hardly cut it. For a 500-word translation at Google Answers, you can expect to pay about \$100.

5.4 It's Too Expensive!

Yes, we're waiting for a Google Answers India, just like Yahoo! brought out Yahoo! Answers India. Some decent rupee prices, please. In the meanwhile, you can have fun at the site answering peoples' questions—as a Commenter, after having procured an Answers ID.

5.5 What Goes On At The Site

So how do you start? You first need a flavour for what goes on at the site. Like we said, it's not just submit-question-and-get-answer. Here's a typical "dialogue" in regards to a question. We made this one up, but it's inspired by a real dialogue at Google Answers. We're putting in this dialogue here so:

- a. You get an idea that it doesn't have to be advanced research questions that are asked
- b. You get the idea that the Answerers are more like regular people than you might think
- c. You get an idea of the freedom that Commenters have in regards to posting their comments

The cast: Questioner, Answerer, Commenter. Remember that Questioner is paying; Answerer will get paid; and Commenter is there for the fun of it.

Questioner : I need pictures of the KASHMIR PARADISE.

Answerer : Do you mean Indian Kashmir or Pakistani Kashmir?

Questioner : I mean the illegally Indian-occupied Kashmir

Commenter: Questioner, please don't get political here. Everyone here would appreciate it if you'd be to the point. Answerer didn't know you call it "Indian-occupied Kashmir."

Answerer : Questioner, I can help you find pictures of Kashmir. Please clarify if the Kashmir Valley is what you mean.

Questioner : Yes I mean independent Kashmir valley country

Commenter: I suppose you could just do an image search on "Kashmir" and find your pics... besides, here's one great place to get started: (www.xyz.com)

Answerer : Here's what I've come up with, Questioner. Kashmir does seem like a beautiful place! Some links for you to browse through: (www.abc.com, ...)

Questioner : I want to make clarification... these images are NOT high-res I want better pics please please help me. Kashmir is THE PARADISE on the earth.